

Field CHA-029

41 acres in Champaign County, Illinois. What the satellite record shows for the 2026 season.

Prepared Oct 6, 2026
Imagery through Oct 2, 2026
Villicus



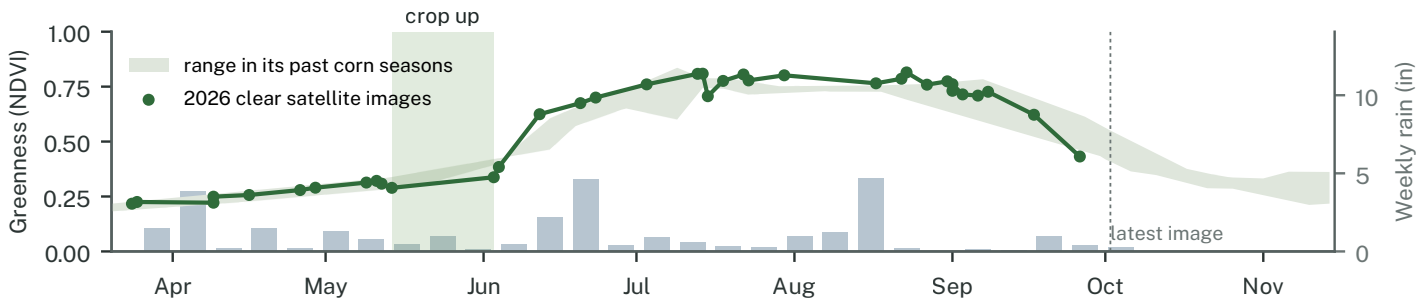
USDA NAIP aerial photo, 2023. Field boundary in yellow; numbered areas match the list below.

2026 crop	Corn (high confidence)
Crop came up	between May 14 and Jun 3, so likely planted Apr 30 to May 27
Harvest	crop still green in the last clear image (Sep 26)
After the 2025 harvest	Tilled (fall); residue dropped between Oct 16, 2025 and Oct 31, 2025
Winter 2025-26	Unclear: a little green in 7 winter images, below the cover-crop threshold
Season greenness	2nd greenest of its 4 corn seasons since 2020; 7th percentile of 1,520 Champaign County corn fields

2019 Soybeans	2020 Corn	2021 Soybeans	2022 Corn	2023 Soybeans	2024 Corn	2025 Soybeans	2026 Corn
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Crop by year: USDA Cropland Data Layer 2019-2025; 2026 from our model.

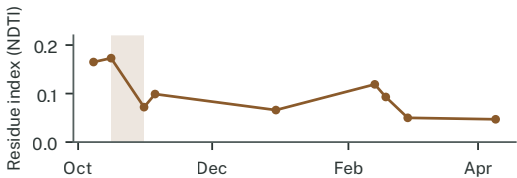
The 2026 season



After the 2025 harvest



Oct 16, 2025, Sentinel-2 (before)
Oct 31, 2025, Sentinel-2 (after)



Worth a look

- 7.2 acres that stay less green than the rest of the field in mid-summer (2024, 2026). Often drainage, compaction or a wet spot; worth walking.
- 4.2 acres ran about 2.8 °C warmer than the rest of the field in July-August 2026, a common sign of crop stress.

This field is in corn for 2026, and the crop was up by Jun 3. Harvest has not shown up in the imagery yet; the latest clear image is from Sep 26. Through the summer it stayed behind most corn fields in the county (7th percentile on greenness), which tracks crop vigor but is not a yield estimate. There are 2 areas worth a look on the next visit, marked on the aerial photo; the imagery shows where, not why.

Evidence. Dates above rest on these satellite scenes: Oct 16 2025, tillage (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Oct 31 2025, tillage (S2B T16TDK orbit 126); May 14 2026, crop up (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Jun 3 2026, crop up (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Aug 23 2026, peak (Landsat 8 path/row 023032); Sep 26 2026, dry-down, harvest (S2B T16TDK orbit 126). The chart and winter checks use 78 clear images from Aug 2025 on, all listed in the field record file.

How it was made. Greenness is NDVI and the residue index is NDTI, averaged 10 m inside the boundary (USDA NASS Crop Sequence Boundaries). Crop up is when greenness first passed 0.30; planting is estimated 1-2 weeks earlier. Hot spots use Landsat 8/9 surface temperature. Season greenness tracks crop vigor and is not a yield estimate.